

359 Make a leaf-stencil bag

45
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The natural world contains many beautiful designs. Why not stencil one of them onto a cloth bag? Leaves work particularly well for this project, and you can use more than one shape, if you like.

What you need

- Leaves • Stencil paper
- Pen • Craft knife • Plate
- Fabric paint • Cloth bag • Wax paper
- Sponges



1 Trace around your chosen leaf on a piece of stencil paper. Ask an adult to help you cut out the shape with the knife.



2 Cut sponges into 2–3 pieces. Put fabric paint on the plate. Dip a sponge piece into the paint and stencil it on paper to practice.



3 When you're ready, slip a piece of wax paper inside the bag to stop the paint from bleeding through, then sponge your stencils onto the bag.



360 Make leaf prints

20
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Use leaves as stamps to make cards, book covers, or wrapping paper. Brush a layer of paint over a leaf surface, press it down on paper, and smooth with your hand before lifting it off.

